Internal Memo: Closure of the Basement Stores and New River Level Stages

Sawan Wari Heritage Archive, Nakhon Sawan · Ref. ADM-MEMO-2026-31 · 14 October 2026

To: All staff, volunteers and reading room attendants
From: Kanokwan Srisuk, Director (Room 2-01, ext. 201)
Copy: Duangporn Chaiyasit, Head of Collections; Thawatchai Inthara, Facilities and Flood Officer
Subject: Permanent closure of basement stores B1 and B2, relocation timetable and revised flood stages, effective 1 November 2026

1. Background

On the night of 22 September 2026 river water entered basement store B2 through the cable duct under the east loading bay. About 4 cm of water stood on the floor for six hours before the pump cleared it. No boxes were wet because the lowest shelf in B2 is 15 cm above the floor, but 38 boxes of the Phayuha Khiri land deed collection were moved upstairs in a hurry and 6 of them were damaged in handling. The Board of Trustees reviewed the incident on 9 October 2026 and approved the decisions in this memo.

2. Decision

Basement stores B1 and B2 will no longer be used for any archival material. From 1 November 2026 no new accessions may be placed in either room. All existing holdings will be moved to the new store on level 3 (Room 3-10, the former staff training room), which has been fitted with mobile shelving for 2,400 standard boxes. The basement will only hold empty boxes, cleaning supplies and the spare pump.

The relocation runs in three phases:

- Phase 1, 2 to 20 November 2026: B2 holdings, starting with the land deed collection and the municipal maps.
- Phase 2, 23 November to 18 December 2026: B1 holdings, starting with photographs and negatives.
- Phase 3, 5 to 29 January 2027: oversize items and the newspaper bound volumes, which need the hired stair lift.

The reading room stays open during Phases 1 and 2, but requests for items from B1 or B2 will be served within 3 working days instead of the usual same day. During Phase 3 the reading room closes on Mondays and Tuesdays so the stair lift can use the main corridor.

> **Note.** The 6 damaged deed boxes are not part of the move. They stay in the conservation lab (Room 1-04) until the conservator from Chiang Mai has assessed them, expected in the week of 16 November 2026.

3. Revised river level stages

Our flood stages now use the reading on the archive's own gauge board at the Pier 2 steps, read twice a day (08:00 and 16:00) by the security guard on duty and entered in the River Log. Until 31 October 2026

Fictional document created for testing a question-answering system. All names, figures and organisations are invented.

the stages were based on the provincial rainfall warnings, which proved too slow in September.

- Stage 1, Watch: gauge at 2.80 m or more. Facilities checks the pump and the duct seals daily and reads the gauge every 2 hours during opening hours.
- Stage 2, Prepare: gauge at 3.40 m or more. Sandbags are placed at the east loading bay and the basement door, and anything left in the basement is lifted onto pallets.
- Stage 3, Protect: gauge at 3.90 m or more. The reading room closes to the public, the ground floor exhibition cases are emptied to level 2, and the main electricity board for the basement is switched off.

On 22 September the gauge reached 3.72 m, so under the new rules the archive would have been at Stage 2 about 30 hours before the water came in.

4. Who declares a stage

Thawatchai Inthara declares Stages 1 and 2 and informs all staff by the LINE group "SWHA Duty". Only the Director can declare Stage 3, or the Head of Collections if the Director cannot be reached within 1 hour. A stage is lowered only after the gauge has stayed below its threshold for 24 hours. Volunteers do not move collection items at Stage 3; they help with sandbags and visitor information only.

5. What to do if you find water in a store

1. Do not switch on lights or equipment if water is touching any socket or cable. Leave the room and call security on ext. 100.
2. Call Thawatchai Inthara on 081 552 4093 (24 hours). If he does not answer within 15 minutes, call the Director.
3. Photograph the room and the water line before anything is moved, and note the time and the gauge reading.
4. Move only boxes that are already wet or within 10 cm of the water, using the yellow crates kept outside Room 1-04. Record every box number on the Emergency Move Sheet (form SWHA-F12).
5. Hand the sheet to the Head of Collections before the end of your shift. Wet paper must reach the conservation lab within 48 hours so it can be frozen before mould starts.

6. Staff time and training

Each department lends 2 staff to the relocation team on Wednesdays and Thursdays during Phases 1 and 2. Overtime for weekend moving is paid at the archive's holiday rate of 1.5 times the normal hourly rate, capped at 12 hours per person per month. All staff who will handle boxes must attend the 90-minute safe lifting and box handling session in Room 2-05 on either 28 or 30 October 2026, starting at 13:30. Register with Duangporn Chaiyasit (ext. 214) by 24 October.

The updated Flood Readiness Plan, version 3.0, replaces version 2.2 and is in the shared folder under Facilities. Questions on the move go to Duangporn Chaiyasit; questions on the stages and the River Log go to Thawatchai Inthara (ext. 118).

Fictional document created for testing a question-answering system. All names, figures and organisations are invented.